ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** agricultural growth and trade in the Second Urbanisation	Dating by objects
2	**(a)** independent sources can confirm or challenge each other	Cross-checking
3	**(a)** south India traded with the Roman world	Evidence of trade
4	**(c)** one-sided praise from a court poet	Bias
5	**(a)** transport and fertile land	Location
6	**(c)** it symbolises strength, courage and dhamma	National values
7	**(d)** Satavahana - Pratishthana	Capitals
8	**(d)** Guptas relied more on feudatories and land grants	Decentralised
9	**(d)** rivalry to control routes and resources	Competition
10	**(a)** Greek ambassador may misunderstand customs	Source bias
11	**(a)** it shows early development of the decimal system	Mathematics
12	**(b)** to display cultural refinement	Image-making
13	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true, but the strength of Magadha does not explain how mahajanapadas were formed.
14	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true, but the origin of the symbol does not explain the number of spokes.
15	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true, but the Nashik record does not explain why the naming custom existed.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Easier to collect (1); Standard measure (1).	1+1
17	Issued by the king (1); Dated by regnal year (1).	1+1
18	Name donors (1); Show patronage (1).	1+1
19	Praise the king (1); Omit defeats (1).	1+1
20	Markets at junctions (1); Rest stops (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Agriculture (1); Weapons (1); Revenue (1).	1+1+1
22	Edicts (1); Arthashastra (1); Indica (1).	1+1+1
23	Ports (1); Revenue (1); Patronage (1).	1+1+1
24	Achievements (1); Elite focus (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Specialisation (1); Inequality (1); Cities (1).	1+1+1
25	Weakened states (1); Contact (1); Mauryan rise (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Revenue (1); Craft demand (1); Foreign contacts (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

26	(i) Magadha (1). (ii) Punch-marked coins (1). (iii) To control who entered and left (1). (iv) Taxes gave income to pay the army and officials (1); with this strength rulers could protect the state and build forts and roads (1).	1+1+1+2
27	Dynasties (1); Trade (1); Art (1); Religion (1); Foreign contacts (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Titles (1); Feudatories (1); Land grants (1); Revenue (1); Judgement (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** prosperity and social inequality existed together	Nuanced picture
2	**(d)** questioning of rituals and social change	Intellectual climate
3	**(d)** guilds made donations and were recorded	Donations
4	**(d)** cross-checking sources	Method
5	**(a)** spread of agriculture and rise of temple economy	Economic change
6	**(d)** participation was limited to a certain group	Limitations
7	**(d)** Greek and Indian art and ideas meeting	Contact
8	**(d)** donor inscriptions on stupas	Local records
9	**(b)** one is by a court poet, the other by an outsider	Source type
10	**(a)** many coins and goods from distant places	Evidence
11	**(a)** the vast extent of Ashoka's empire	Geographic spread
12	**(d)** Udayagiri-Khandagiri	Kharavela's Hathigumpha
13	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	The protective layer is the reason the iron does not rust.
14	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	R explains what made them republics.
15	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	His remorse is the reason for giving up war.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	State famine policy (1); Granary system (1).	1+1
17	Poetry (1); Idealised (1).	1+1
18	Weak centre (1); Strong feudatories (1).	1+1
19	Growth of cities (1); Shift from villages (1).	1+1
20	Show power (1); Durability (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Hindu patronage (1); Buddhist centres (1); Tolerance (1).	1+1+1
22	Taxila: learning (1); Pataliputra: capital (1); Routes (1).	1+1+1
23	Remorse (1); Concern (1); Tolerance (1).	1+1+1
24	Taxila (1); Mathura (1); Trade (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Faxian (1); Texts (1); Inscriptions (1).	1+1+1
25	Rise of Magadha (1); Military pressure (1); Limited base (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Unity (1); Control (1); Welfare (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	(i) Dhana Nanda (1). (ii) Chandragupta Maurya (1). (iii) Pataliputra (1). (iv) Magadha was already a powerful mahajanapada with a strong army (1); its fertile Ganga plain gave wealth from farming and trade (1).	1+1+1+2

27	Fragmentation (1); Regional strengths (1); Trade (1); Culture (1); Conclusion (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Aryabhata (1); Varahamihira (1); Medicine (1); Zero (1); Transmission (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it provides a fixed starting point for dating	Chronology
2	**(b)** Aryabhatiya	Text
3	**(b)** economic strength of guilds and patronage	Evidence
4	**(c)** to spread Buddhism and dhamma	Missions
5	**(b)** to gain fame and legitimacy	Patronage
6	**(b)** carved panels of Vishnu's avatars	Early temple
7	**(d)** iron weapons and elephants	Resources
8	**(a)** it was widely understood in most of his empire	Reach
9	**(a)** no strong central power and rise of regional rulers	Reorganisation
10	**(d)** secure diplomatic and political support	Statecraft
11	**(d)** competition for land, resources and power	Conflict
12	**(c)** it helps control territory and revenue	Infrastructure
13	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.	Both are true; the starting year is a fact about the calendar, not the reason it was adopted (in 1957).
14	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.	A court poet writing in praise explains why the record is full of praise.
15	**(d)** A is false but R is true.	A is false, they were mostly of silver; R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Weak centre (1); Regional strength (1).	1+1
17	Village names (1); Taxes (1).	1+1
18	Texts may be biased (1); Objects give direct evidence (1).	1+1
19	Maximum readership (1); Along roads (1).	1+1
20	Foreign coins (1); Ship symbols (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Diverse subjects (1); Silk Route (1); Art styles (1).	1+1+1
22	Faxian (1); Prashasti (1); Cross-check (1).	1+1+1
23	Transport (1); Fertility (1); Defence (1).	1+1+1
24	Values (1); Unity (1); Continuity (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Content (1); Bias (1); Corroboration (1).	1+1+1
25	Prabhavati (1); Education (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Occupations (1); Facilities (1); Inequality (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	(i) The Deccan (1). (ii) Nashik (1). (iii) Sea trade (1). (iv) It names the king and records his achievements (1); it is a contemporary record, so it gives reliable evidence about the period (1).	1+1+1+2
27	Inscriptions (1); Coins (1); Literature (1); Monuments (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Science (1); Literature (1); Art (1); Education (1); Significance (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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